St. Joseph's Anglo-Chinese School
F.6 English Language
Grammar – Lesson 5 (Enhancing Accuracy)
Teacher's notes · 60 minutes · Lesson 2 of 3 before the mock

TEACHER'S NOTES — keys and corrections in red. Not for students.

Level 2: Simple sentences are well formed.

Level 3: Simple sentences, and some complex sentences are well formed.

Level 4: A range of sentence structures is used accurately and appropriately; errors do not affect overall clarity.

PART 1: LESSON AT A GLANCE

Time	Stage	Teacher	Students
0–3	Frame	Say: 'Nothing today is marked. You write, practise, then fix your own paragraph.'	Pens out.
3–18	Cold write	Silent, 15 min, no notes. Hold the clock.	Write article introduction, approx. 75 words. Level 3: star one complex sentence.
18–26	Error types	Board: the four codes. Walk three sentences through them.	Copy codes onto error card.
26–34	Five practice sentences	Two are already correct.	Fix errors. Self-mark.
34–42	8-error hunt	8 min. Collect totals for chart.	Find 8 errors. Count: caught ___ / 8.
42–48	Own-text hunt	5 min. Circle only.	Apply codes to own paragraph.
48–53	Fix	Enforce ten-word rule. Peer-check.	Fix in second colour.
53–56	Transfer write	3 min. 'The First Day at the Bakery', approx. 40 words.	New paragraph.
56–60	Peer proofread	4 min. Swap, apply codes, sign.	Mark codes on partner's page.

PART 2: WRITE NOW (15 MINUTES)

Frame it: 'This paragraph is not marked. You will fix it yourself in forty minutes.'

The task:

You have interviewed a past student who left a well-paid job as a doctor to follow a lifelong dream. Write an article about this past student for the school magazine.
Write an introduction to the article (approx. 75 words).
15 minutes, silent, pens only. No notes, no dictionaries, no talking.
Level 3 group: also include ONE complex sentence and put a star beside it.

Do not correct anything while they write. Their real errors are the raw material.

PART 3: THE MOST COMMON TYPES OF ERRORS

The four codes:

Code	What it covers	Example
S	Sentence boundary: no verb, no subject, two sentences joined by a comma, a fragment	Her work as a nurse was tiring, she never complained.
V	Verb: ending, tense, missing ‘be’, subject-verb agreement	No one is surprised when a doctor work at weekends.
W	Word form: right word, wrong form	The patient was very worrying about the operation.
N	Noun and article	It was a honour to interview such a dedicated doctor.

Say this: ‘A sentence passes both questions or it does not exist. There is no third question.’

PART 4: PRACTICE SENTENCES (8 MINUTES)

Five sentences. Two already correct. Treat this as training the eye, not a test.

1. The patient was very worrying about the operation.
2. Dr Lee left the hospital in 2020, he opened a clinic in Wan Chai.
3. Working twelve hours every day, she never missed a shift.
4. No one is surprised when a doctor work at weekends.
5. It was a honour to interview such a dedicated doctor.

No.	As printed	Error	Corrected sentence	Code
1	The patient was very worrying about the operation.	Word form	The patient was very worried about the operation.	W
2	Dr Lee left the hospital in 2020, he opened a clinic in Wan Chai.	Comma splice	Dr Lee left the hospital in 2020. He opened a clinic in Wan Chai.	S
3	Working twelve hours every day, she never missed a shift.	Correct	No change.	—
4	No one is surprised when a doctor work at weekends.	Subject-verb agreement	No one is surprised when a doctor works at weekends.	V
5	It was a honour to interview such a dedicated doctor.	Article	It was an honour to interview such a dedicated doctor.	N

Sentences 3 and 5 are the ones students typically miss: sentence 3 looks complete because the participial phrase is grammatically correct; sentence 5 is wrong only because of the article.

PART 5: THE 8-ERROR HUNT (8 MINUTES)

Project or photocopy. The errors are the same families the practice sentences trained.

Dr Jason Lai practiced medicine in a public hospital, he left that job in 2023 to follow a lifelong dream

He earned over a hundred thousand dollars a month and life was secure, every morning he woke up feeling empty

He quit his job, sell his apartment and opened a small bakery in Mui Wo

Bringing fresh bread to elderly residents who had walked an hour to the nearest shop

The bakery was deliberately kept cheap so no one is left out

Today, he deliver eighty loaves every morning and his parents felt very worrying about his future

It is a example of courage for all of us.

No.	As printed	The error	Correction	Code
1	… hospital, he left …	Comma splice	Dr Jason Lai practiced medicine in a public hospital. He left that job in 2023 to follow a lifelong dream.	S
2	… secure, every morning …	Comma splice	He earned over a hundred thousand dollars a month and life was secure. Every morning he woke up feeling empty.	S
3	… sell his apartment …	Wrong verb form (parallel tense)	He quit his job, sold his apartment and opened a small bakery in Mui Wo.	V
4	Bringing fresh bread …	Fragment — no finite verb	He brings fresh bread to elderly residents who had walked an hour to the nearest shop.	S
5	… no one is left out	Wrong tense	The bakery was deliberately kept cheap so no one was left out.	V
6	… he deliver eighty loaves …	Subject-verb agreement	Today, he delivers eighty loaves every morning …	V
7	… felt very worrying about …	Word form	… his parents felt very worried about his future.	W
8	… a example of courage	Article	It is an example of courage for all of us.	N

COMPOSITION: 3 S / 3 V / 1 W / 1 N.

CONTENT / ORGANISATION / LANGUAGE REMINDERS

Use these in class to show students that the plant text is a model answer WITH errors, not errors in a weak answer.

Sentence 1:

Content: establishes who (Dr Jason Lai), what (practiced medicine), when (2023), why (lifelong dream). Organisation: opens with the interview subject and the dramatic decision. Language: the comma splice is the only error — the information is complete and specific (public hospital, 2023).

Teaching note: This opening does exactly what an article introduction should do: name the person, state the change, and give the reason. The error is mechanical (one comma), not conceptual.

Sentence 2:

Content: establishes the contrast (high salary vs. emotional emptiness). Organisation: creates tension before the change. Language: the comma splice fuses two independent observations.

Teaching note: Teach students that contrast paragraphs need punctuation, not just commas. The ideas themselves ('hundred thousand dollars', 'woke up feeling empty') are exactly the kind of specific detail that makes Content score at Level 4.

Sentence 3:

Content: three concrete actions (quit, sell, open) with specific location (Mui Wo). Organisation: moves from problem to solution. Language: parallel verb error — 'sell' should match 'quit' and 'opened' in past tense.

Teaching note: Parallel structure is a Level 4+ feature, but only when all parts match. One wrong verb breaks the pattern. This is a high-value teaching point: the sentence is ambitious, which is good, but ambition requires accuracy.

Sentence 4:

Content: defines the dream (fresh bread for elderly) with specific obstacle (hour walk). Organisation: shows impact beyond the subject. Language: the fragment looks like a sentence but has no finite verb.

Teaching note: This is the subtlest error. Students who hunt for 'obvious' mistakes will miss it. The participial phrase is a good structure (Level 4), but it must attach to a main clause with a finite verb.

Sentences 5–6:

Content: current operations (kept cheap, eighty loaves) + family reaction. Organisation: shifts from past narrative to present evidence. Language: tense error (is/was), subject-verb error (deliver/delivers), word-form error (worrying/worried).

Teaching note: Three errors in two sentences because the writer changed tense mid-paragraph without adjusting every verb. This is exactly what Level 3 writers do: they attempt a range of structures but lose control when switching time frames.

Sentence 7:

Content: universal meaning (courage, all of us). Organisation: closes with a takeaway for the reader. Language: article error before a vowel sound.

Teaching note: A small error at the end undermines an otherwise strong conclusion. The ideas are fully developed; the Language error is minor but noticeable. This is what separates Level 3 from Level 4: consistent accuracy across the whole text.

PART 6: THEIR OWN PARAGRAPH (10 MINUTES)

Hunt (5 min): apply the four codes to the paragraph written before any teaching. Circle, do not fix.

Fix (5 min): second colour, at most ten words, no restructuring. Peer-check in pairs.

The tally strip replaces the old 'error card' — no copying of wrong sentences. The script IS the record.

PART 7: TRANSFER WRITE (3 MINUTES)

'The First Day at the Bakery', about 40 words. A new paragraph forces production, not just polishing.

PART 8: PEER PROOFREAD (4 MINUTES)

Swap paragraphs. Partner applies the four codes, circles errors, writes codes at the bottom, and signs.

PART 9: WHAT TO WATCH

- Do not mark the cold write. Not a tick.
- Do not teach before the write.
- The planted-text score is a gauge, not a mark.
- Keep the plant at 8 errors and the same length (≈ 100 words) every lesson.
- The proofreading window shrinks across the three lessons (5, then 4, then 3 minutes).
- Over-correction is the signal to name out loud: ‘You changed three correct sentences.’
- Never read out one student's count. Class totals only, or seat numbers.

PART 10: CARRY-OVER TO LESSON 3 (IF THERE IS ONE)

Target: sentence variety — combining short sentences correctly.

Plant: same length, 8 errors, 2 S / 2 V / 2 W / 2 N.

Write: a conclusion paragraph (≈ 40 words) — where writers rush and compress.